

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3307

Name

DaNae Woodard

Emailwoodard.danae@gmail.com**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

San Diego, CA, USA

Nationality

American

When did or will you finish your PhD?

December 2021

University Education

PhD | Biological Chemistry | December 2021

Bachelor of Science | Chemistry | May 2015

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I am enthusiastically applying to become a Science Corps Fellow because of the unique opportunity to teach science to underserved students in a global manner. Throughout my academic journey, I have had the privilege of teaching, mentoring and supporting underserved students in STEM in my local community, and extending this worldwide would allow me to gain more diverse perspectives for educating students. As an underrepresented scientist myself, I know firsthand the impact that access to quality STEM education can have on your livelihood and future at a young age. Thus, the mission of the Science Corps aligns perfectly with my continued efforts to educate and inspire students to pursue degrees in STEM fields. Furthermore,

this fellowship would allow me to build upon my current pedagogical training by incorporating new skills such as designing scientific curriculum and developing STEM teaching materials, which will help me to support student knowledge. I am convinced that being a Science Corps Fellow will foster a supportive environment for my continued growth as a scientist, mentor, and educator so that I may better serve to uplift the next generation of students to pursue STEM. I am both patient and eager to begin this journey.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

As a postdoctoral fellow at the University of California, San Diego (UCSD), I am a part of the NIH/NIGMS-sponsored Institutional Research and Academic Career Development Award (IRACDA) program where I have received extensive pedagogical training in active learning techniques to equip me in effectively teaching students. Through the IRACDA program, I have had opportunities to conduct Biology lectures at San Diego City College (a minority-serving institution) and San Diego State University (SDSU); participate in the annual National Institute of Scientific Teaching Workshop to implement evidence-based teaching in STEM; and co-lead teaching workshops for undergraduates, postdoctoral scholars and faculty at UCSD, San Diego City College and SDSU. Previously, I served as a mentor for the Foundation for C.H.O.I.C.E., a non-profit organization that encourages underserved high school students to graduate and pursue STEM careers. Additionally, I have had wonderful experiences teaching underrepresented high school and undergraduate students in the laboratory setting while guiding them on research projects. Finally, because communicating my research is important, I have had the pleasure of traveling both nationally and abroad to research conferences to broaden my perspectives and network with other scientists. I believe that a culmination of these experiences are relevant for the Science Corps Fellowship.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

As I write this response, I can't help but think of all of the academic experiences that have shaped my journey thus far, which includes my passion for teaching science. Thus, my short and long-term goals are to become a professor at a reputable, teaching-intensive institution where I can apply my acquired pedagogical skills to foster an inclusive and active learning environment for students interested in biology and chemistry. I would also like to be in a position to extend and encourage students to pursue various STEM opportunities like I have been afforded, as they progress in their careers. These include participating in summer undergraduate research internships, applying for graduate schools, becoming an IRACDA fellow and also applying to be a Science Corps Fellow as a way to challenge their worldview and perspectives in science. In ten years' time, I see myself as a fulfilled, tenured professor who, along with a strong teaching community, helps pave the way for the next generation of students to continue to shape, impact and serve in STEM education and outreach. The Science Corps would be a valuable steppingstone to help me to achieve these goals.

CV/Resume[Woodard-DR Curriculum-Vitae.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

Other

Any other comments/questions?

My desired start date and location of placement would be August 2025 at the Central Visayan Institute Foundation (CVIF) in Jagna (Bohol). However, I am also open to an earlier start date, if necessary. Thank you for taking the time to review my application.

[Science Corps](#)